

FIRST PERSON

NAMRATA SINGH
SYMBIOSIS-Batch of 2004

In B-schools, the balance is obviously tilted towards the male population because in our country, gender does predefine education and expectation to a large extent. My field, human resource, is one of those few management areas which are considered women-centric. It is because this discipline gets typecasted as a 'touchy feely' function. But this is not true. This myth should be broken because it is not an easy career, but one where companies have increasingly started adopting a tough "result-on-investment" approach.

DR HARSH SHARMA
ISB-Batch of 2006

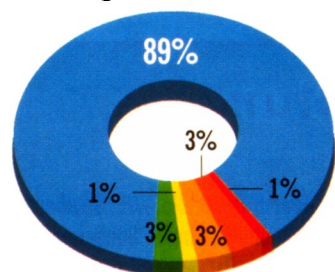
The fact that I am not from an engineering background worked to my advantage because there is a severe paucity of management graduates in the medical sector. I do not think that a technical background is necessary to do well in a B-school. I had to work harder initially because I had to deal with the basics such as finance and accounts. Diversity was the main feature of my batch at ISB. My classmates were lawyers, architects and ex-army officers. In an MBA class, this is important because it gives you a glimpse into different professions.

BHASKAR PAUL

VIKRAM SHARMA

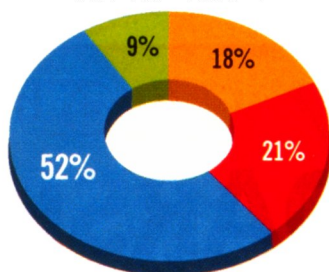
HOW ENGINEERS DOMINATE TOP B-SCHOOLS*

Indian Institute of Management, Ahmedabad



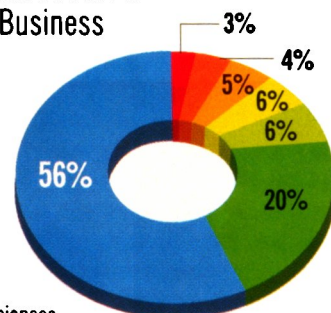
■ Arts ■ Science ■ Engineering
■ Business ■ Others ■ Commerce

Mudra Institute of Communications



■ Commerce ■ Science
■ Arts ■ Engineering

Indian School of Business



■ Sciences
■ Medicine ■ Accounts/Finance ■ Engineering
■ Others ■ Business Management ■ Economics

* Class of 2009

director of the institute.

If the present examination criterion is so biased, one wonders why the B-schools persist on sticking to the same formula. Are number crunching abilities that crucial in the making of a good manager? Evidently not. Says Anant K. Sundaram, faculty director of executive education at the Tuck School of Business, Dartmouth, the US, "I can confidently say that they do not contribute significantly to one's ability. Skills such as team leading, communicating effectively, having an ability to work across

cultures are more important."

The situation in some of the best B-schools in the world is quite different. Forty-two per cent students at Harvard Business School, class of 2010, are from humanities or social science background. Its Indian equivalent—IIM-Ahmedabad—has a paltry 1 per cent arts graduates. This could be explained by the fact that the qualifying exam for international schools, Graduate Management Aptitude Test (GMAT), is much more balanced and comprehensive. Besides, these schools give equal importance to factors such as prior